# Chapter 1

# Social Media Analytics : An Overview

## What is social media analytics?

Social media analytics refers to the collection of data and metrics that help you measure your overall social media performance. This helps marketers understand which types of social media content best resonate with their audience so they can shape and adapt their strategy accordingly. Reviewing social media analytics reports empowers teams to make data-informed decisions about how to transform their marketing efforts and grow their businesses.

Marketers can conduct social media analysis natively on platforms such as Instagram, TikTok and X (formerly known as Twitter). Marketers can also use social media management software like Sprout to dive deeper into the numbers.

## What is the importance of social media analytics?

Social media analytics help marketers with a number of tasks, from informing their strategy to planning campaigns and inspiring content ideas. There are five major benefits of tracking social analytics:

### 1. Trendspotting

Trendspotting is the act of pinpointing upcoming trends before they're mainstream. Keeping a close eye on your social media analytics can help you do just that. Some of the trends that your social media analytics can help you determine include:

- Which platforms are gaining or losing traction and popularity